



Windows 8 to offer groundbreaking features

The Windows 8 operating system (OS) that is speculated to launch in October this year is said to have many groundbreaking features—according to reviews of its consumer preview version.

Windows 8 boots in just six seconds compared to Windows 7, which takes an average of 90 seconds. The task manager has been redesigned to offer simple accessibility and a more detailed interface. The OS is said to have Near Field Communication (NFC) support too. Additionally, users can open an ISO image on the hard drive and open it in Explorer as a virtual optical drive, access its contents, and even copy or paste files elsewhere on the hard drive for use with other programs.

Microsoft has clubbed the Ribbon interface with Windows Explorer in Windows 8, where it provides an easy way to check file attributes and sort files. Also, catching up with Apple's Mac App Store, Microsoft Windows 8 offers the Windows Store through which users will be able to find, purchase and install Microsoft-approved apps for the OS.

New security camera scans 36 million faces per second

A surveillance camera that can search through data on 36 million faces in

one second has been developed. It is suitable for customers that have a relatively large-scale surveillance system, such as railways, power companies, law enforcement authorities and large stores—according to the company Hitachi Kokusai Electric that developed the camera.

Earlier, authorities used to spend hours trawling through CCTV footage to find an individual. But using this camera, they can now capture a person's face in the blink of an eye—reports RT.com. The technology can find a face matching against either surveillance footage or a photo.

"This high speed is achieved by detecting faces through image recognition when the footage from the camera

is recorded, and also by grouping similar faces," Seiichi Hirai, researcher at Hitachi Kokusai Electric, told DigInfo TV. Reportedly, the search results are instant and possible candidates are immediately shown to the searcher. Limitations do exist, such as the faces must turn within 30 degrees of the camera and be 40x40 pixels in size.

Indian woman researcher in MIT Technology's list of innovators

Priyanka Sharma, who developed a cost-effective chip for monitoring pesticide levels in agricultural products, has featured in MIT Technology Review's India list of innovators under the age of 35 for 2012. She is the only woman to have made it to the list.

Sharma aimed at developing inexpensive and reliable techniques for effective field monitoring of toxic molecules in agro products, as part of her assignment at the Institute of Microbial Technology. Her work includes a low-cost disposable electrochemical sensor for detecting pollutants in the environment. It can also be used in clinical diagnosis.

By making trace pesticide detection simple and affordable, Sharma has set the ball rolling for various game-changing innovations in several adjacent domains—according to Technology Review India. The chip took four years to design and develop.



Hitachi's latest surveillance camera system makes tracking of millions of people all the more easier. It can compare a face it has just captured with 36 million on record in just one second

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